The restoration of the Maharaja's rule in 1905 was not a reversal of the status quo ante that existed in 1889 when he was dispossessed. Riders were imposed on the Maharaja's authority, and he was effectively ring-fenced by the Government of India. The Maharaja could not take any consequential decision without the consent of the Government of India's plenipotentiary, the Resident. Furthermore, the British policy of divide and rule was used to the hilt by the Resident, who encouraged Raja Amar Singh to shadow every action of the Maharaja. For his loyalty to the Government of India, Raja Amar Singh was rewarded with the guarantee that his only son Hari Singh, born in 1895, would succeed Pratap Singh as the next Maharaja. This was in line with the principle of primogeniture, given that Hari Singh was a direct male descendant of Maharaja Gulab Singh. Further, given the distrust between Pratap Singh and the Government of India, the latter was never going to endorse any of Pratap Singh's nominees. The combined issue of dispossession, restoration and succession overwhelmed Maharaja Pratap Singh throughout his constrained reign, the issue of succession being the most important of the lot. Apart from Raja Amar Singh, Maharaja Pratap Singh had another younger brother named Raja Ram Singh who died childless. Relations between the two brothers, Pratap Singh and Amar Singh, which were contentious even when Maharaja Ranbir Singh was alive, became worse during the period when the British Resident directly ruled the state, a period which also saw Amar Singh's political ambitions peak. The question of deciding Pratap Singh's successor gained more traction, 1889 onwards. He was childless after having lost his only son in infancy. Visibly shattered after the 16-year-long limbo in his rule, Pratap Singh decided to retaliate after he was reinstated as the ruler of the state in 1905. In 1906, it was rumoured that Pratap Singh intended to adopt a distant male relative ostensibly for religious purposes. Obviously, the larger plan was to exclude Hari Singh from succession. The Government of India took up the case with the Maharaja and pointed out that he should not adopt a distant relative, especially when he had a brother and a nephew. Refusing to comply, Pratap Singh pointed out that that wouldn't be feasible; Amar Singh was too old to adopt a son and Hari Singh, being Amar Singh's only